

MEETRA

THE SAGA BIBLE

Game scenarios for every story of the Book of Kings,
and the map of the Realm of the Dawnfire

Design document · v1.0 · 2026

How to Read This Book

The *Shahnameh* (the Book of Kings), finished by Ferdowsi around 1010, tells the story of the world from the first king to the last. It holds dozens of stories that already work like video game chapters: a hero, a journey, a monster, a reward.

This document turns **each major story** into a playable **MeetRa chapter**. There are 44 chapters in three books:

Book	Chapters	Role in MeetRa
I · The Age of First Kings	1–8	Mythic prologue: fire, iron, the Serpent King
II · The Age of Heroes	9–33	The main campaign around Ra, Ember and Saena. Includes the Seven Trials.
III · The Age of Crowns	34–44	Episodic chapters with new heroes after Ra

> **The breeze rule.** MeetRa is inspired by the Shahnameh; it does not retell it. Inside the game every person and place has an **original name** (Ra, Saena, the Dusk Khan, Crownhold...). The original Shahnameh names appear only in the grey "Source" lines of this book, so the team can see where each idea comes from. Full lists are in the appendix.

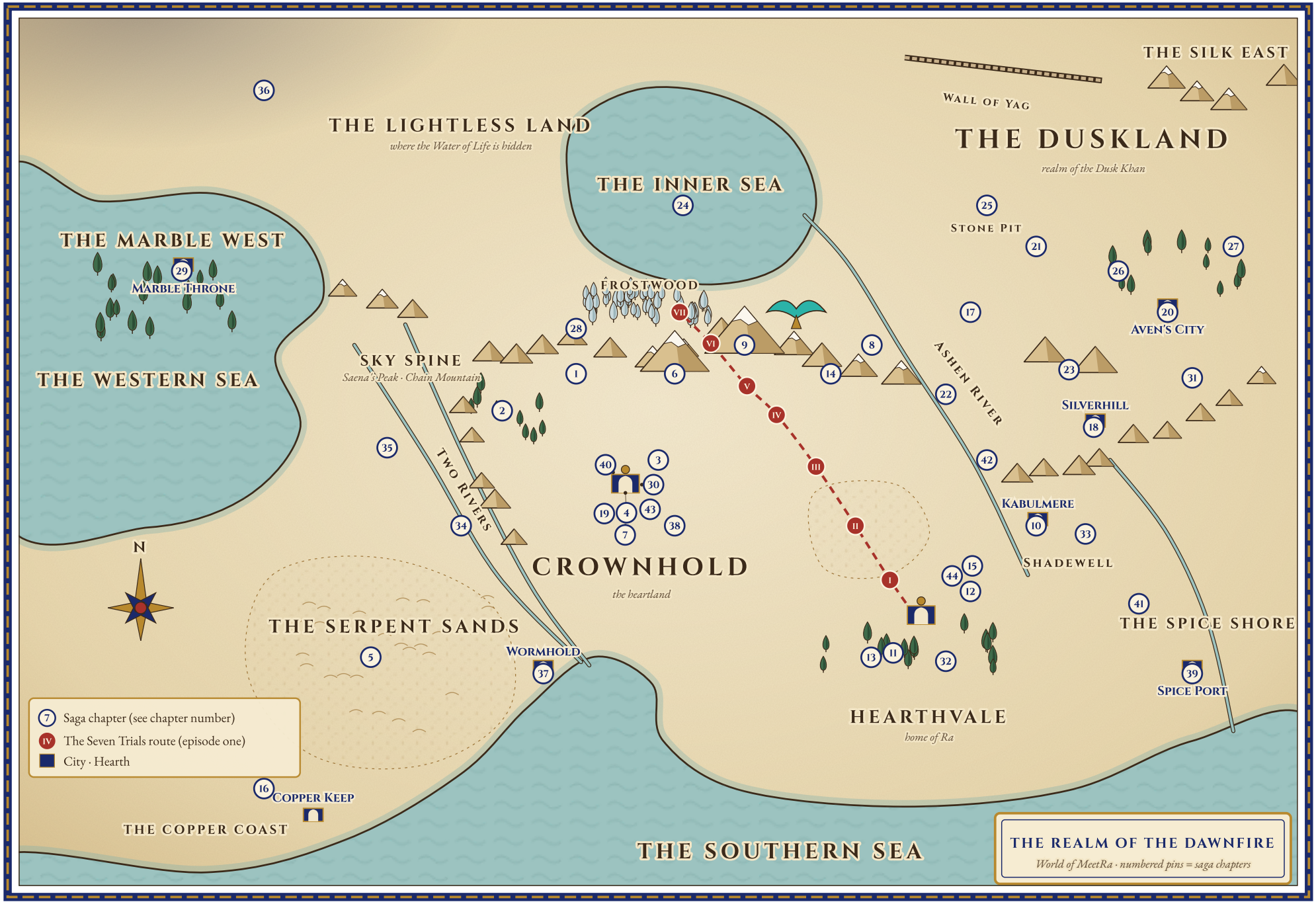
Every chapter card shows

The story	A short summary of the Shahnameh story the chapter is based on
The MeetRa chapter	What the player does: setting, level beats, twist
Boss / set piece	The climax of the chapter
Earns	The new mechanic, item or mode it adds to the game
Map pin	Where it happens on the world map (next page)

Release plan

Release	Title	Chapters	Contents
Episode 1	The Seven Trials	15	The game in development now
Episode 2	Origins of Ra	9–14	Prequel: Saena, Zev, the birth of Ra, Ember
Episode 3	Father and Son	16–18	The Copper Coast, the Seven Hunters, Sorin
Episode 4	The Prince of Fire	19–22	Aven, the garden city, Corin's return, Prince Fen
Episode 5	The Long War	23–28	Sieges, the Whirlwind Ogre, the Stone Pit, the Twelve Duels, the Dusk Khan's end
Episode 6	The Bronze Prince	29–33	Prince Aspen, the Tamarisk Arrow, the death of Ra
Prologue pack	The Age of First Kings	1–8	Short mythic levels; can ship free as a demo
Anthology	The Age of Crowns	34–44	Episodic chapters with new heroes and mini-games

The Realm of the Dawnfire



Chapter Index

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2	**The First Spark**	Hushang and the Discovery of Fire	Sky Spine foothills
3	**The Binder**	Tahmuras the Div-Binder	Crownhold plains
4	**The Radiant Throne**	Jamshid: The Golden Age and the Fall	Crownhold
5	**The Whispering Cook**	Zahhak the Serpent King	Serpent Sands
6	**The Leather Banner**	Kaveh the Blacksmith and Fereydun	Crownhold → Chain Mountain
7	**Three Crowns**	Fereydun Divides the World	Marble West · Duskland · Crownhold
8	**The Grandson's Oath**	Manuchehr's Revenge	Ashen River
9	**The White-Haired Child**	Zal and the Simurgh	Saena's Peak
10	**The Tower of Kabulmere**	Zal and Rudabeh	Kabulmere
11	**Saena's Answer**	The Birth of Rostam	Hearthvale
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13	**Ember**	Rostam Chooses Rakhsh	Hearthvale plains
14	**The Heir on the Mountain**	Kay Qobad from Mount Alborz	Sky Spine
15	**THE SEVEN TRIALS (the current game)**	Kay Kavus in Mazandaran and Rostam's Seven Labours	Hearthvale → Frostwood
16	**The Copper Coast**	Kay Kavus in Hamavaran and the Flying Throne	Copper Coast
17	**The Seven Hunters**	The Hunt of the Seven Heroes	Duskland border
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19	**Through the Fire**	Siavash and the Trial by Fire	Crownhold
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21	**Seven Years Searching**	Giv Brings Kay Khosrow Home	Duskland → Ashen River
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Book I: The Age of First Kings

Chapters 1–8

Myth time. The first rulers learn fire, iron and writing, and the first darkness takes the throne. These chapters work as a playable prologue: short, bright, mythic, with a new tool earned in every one.

1 The Mountain King

Shahnameh source: ***Kayumars and the Black Div***

REGION Sky Spine | PLAY Prologue · tutorial | MAP PIN 1

THE STORY

The first king rules from the mountains, dressed in leopard skin. His son Siamak is killed by the son of Ahriman, and the grieving king raises an army of people and beasts to take revenge.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Play as Prince Tamsin, son of Orem the Mountain King, in a sunlit highland full of friendly animals. The Black Hollow ambushes him at a cliff shrine and the prince falls. Control switches to Orem, who rallies lions, leopards and eagles. Each animal ally teaches one move.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The Black Hollow: a shadow that can only be hit when an eagle ally lights it from above.

EARNS

Animal calls: summon a beast ally for a few seconds.

2 The First Spark

Shahnameh source: ***Hushang and the Discovery of Fire***

REGION Sky Spine foothills | PLAY Puzzle platformer | MAP PIN 2

THE STORY

King Hushang throws a stone at a serpent. It misses, strikes a rock and makes a spark, and fire is born. He also teaches people to mine iron and dig channels.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Kael the Flint-Striker hunts a giant cave serpent through dark tunnels. A missed throw hits flint and lights the first fire. The second half of the level is lit by the player's own torches: light braziers, smelt ore and open water channels to reach the exit.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Cave Serpent: lure it into light so it recoils.

EARNS

The first Hearth (checkpoint fire). This chapter explains why hearths exist in MeetRa.

3 The Binder

Shahnameh source: ***Tahmuras the Div-Binder***

REGION Crownhold plains | PLAY Capture and ride | MAP PIN 3

THE STORY

Tahmuras tames animals and binds the divs with spells and a heavy mace. In exchange for their lives, the defeated divs teach humans thirty kinds of writing.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Taro the Binder rides out on Ahrim, a captured shadow-beast, to stop a horde of Hollows. Weakened enemies can be bound instead of destroyed. Each bound Hollow becomes a glyph that unlocks a script stone.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The Hollow Horde: wave survival on a moving mount.

EARNS

Script Stones: collectible lore. A codex page opens for each one.

4 The Radiant Throne

Shahnameh source: ***Jamshid: The Golden Age and the Fall***

REGION Crownhold | PLAY Builder sequence + escape | MAP PIN 4

THE STORY

Jamshid rules for centuries, building, healing and making the divs carry him through the sky on a jewelled throne. His pride grows until he claims to be divine, and the royal glory, the farr, leaves him.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

A golden-age city builder in miniature: Jarem the Radiant places forges, baths and workshops. Then the pride scene. Jarem's aura, shown as a halo, drains away and the city turns on him. The level ends in a desperate chase through his own collapsing palace.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Set piece: the flying throne crashes. Steer it through towers.

EARNS

Teaches the Aura resource and how it can be lost.

5 The Whispering Cook

Shahnameh source: ***Zahhak the Serpent King***

REGION Serpent Sands | PLAY Stealth · horror | MAP PIN 5

THE STORY

Iblis tempts Prince Zahhak to kill his father. Disguised as a cook, he kisses Zahhak's shoulders and two serpents grow there, which must be fed human brains each day. Zahhak seizes the throne after Jamshid falls.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Play the palace kitchen servants who secretly save one of the two daily victims and smuggle them into the desert. Vexar's serpents sense movement; hide in steam, shadows and crowds. Every rescued person later founds a desert tribe that helps in later chapters.

BOSS / SET PIECE

No fight. A tense escape from the twin serpents at the palace gate.

EARNS

Stealth crouch and hiding spots.

6 The Leather Banner

Shahnameh source: ***Kaveh the Blacksmith and Fereydun***

REGION Crownhold → Chain Mountain | PLAY Rebellion campaign | MAP PIN 6

THE STORY

Kaveh, whose sons were taken for the serpents, raises his leather apron on a spear as a banner and starts a revolt. Young Fereydun, raised in secret, forges an ox-headed mace and overthrows Zahhak, who is chained inside Mount Damavand.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Bram the Smith raises the Leather Banner in the market; the crowd grows as the player frees districts. Faren, raised in secret by a forest cow-herd, joins with the Ox-Head Mace. The final ascent climbs the Chain Mountain to bind Vexar inside it.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Vexar, the Twin-Serpent King: three phases. Each serpent head must be stunned before the king can be struck.

EARNS

Ox-Head Mace: heavy weapon that breaks shields. The Leather Banner rallies allies.

7 Three Crowns

Shahnameh source: ***Fereydun Divides the World***

REGION Marble West · Duskland · Crownhold | PLAY Branching chapter | MAP PIN 7

THE STORY

Fereydun splits the world among his three sons: Salm takes the West, Tur the East and Iraj the heartland. Jealous, the two elder brothers murder Iraj.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

One prologue, three short levels. Play each prince's journey to his land: the marble cities of the West, the open steppe of the East, and the green heart. The final scene is the betrayal at a peace tent, told from Ilan's view.

BOSS / SET PIECE

None. The loss is the point; it sets up the feud for the whole saga.

EARNS

Unlocks the world map and the three main regions.

8 The Grandson's Oath

Shahnameh source: ***Manuchehr's Revenge***

REGION Ashen River | PLAY Battlefield chapter | MAP PIN 8

THE STORY

Iraj's grandson Manuchehr grows up, leads the army against his great-uncles Salm and Tur and kills them both.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Mael leads a small war band across the Ashen River. Large battle levels with formations of soldiers in the background; the player cuts through to the two kings.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Torvak and Sael: a double boss that shares one health bar and switches between ranged and melee.

EARNS

War Horn: a short-range shockwave.

Book II: The Age of Heroes

Chapters 9–33

The heart of the saga and of MeetRa. Ra, Ember the horse and Saena carry most of these chapters. The Seven Trials (chapter 15) is the game being built now; everything around it becomes the full campaign.

9 The White-Haired Child

Shahnameh source: ***Zal and the Simurgh***

REGION Saena's Peak | PLAY Vertical climb · flight | MAP PIN 9

The Story

Sam's son Zal is born with white hair. His father abandons him on a mountain, where the Simurgh raises him in her nest. Sam later repents and brings him home; the Simurgh gives Zal a feather to burn if he ever needs her.

The MeetRa Chapter

Climb Saena's Peak as young Zev, raised by the great bird. Levels are vertical: wind currents, nest platforms, eggs to protect from mountain lynxes. The chapter ends with the father, Sarn the Lionheart, climbing up to ask forgiveness.

Boss / Set Piece

Storm Wyvern that hunts Saena's chicks.

Earns

Saena's first feather. This becomes the core spell later.

10 The Tower of Kabulmere

Shahnameh source: ***Zal and Rudabeh***

REGION Kabulmere | PLAY Romance · diplomacy | MAP PIN 10

The Story

Zal falls in love with Rudabeh, daughter of the king of Kabul, who comes from Zahhak's line. She lets down her long hair from a tower for him to climb. The match causes a crisis between the two families.

The MeetRa Chapter

A lighter chapter. Zev sneaks into Kabulmere by night; Rue lowers her braid from the tower and the player climbs it (a rope mechanic). Daytime is dialogue choices with suspicious lords that change how many guards patrol the night levels.

Boss / Set Piece

None. A chase across rooftops if the plan is discovered.

Earns

Rope climbing, later reused for the Hunter's Lasso.

11 Saena's Answer

Shahnameh source: ***The Birth of Rostam***

REGION Hearthvale | PLAY Short story chapter | MAP PIN 11

THE STORY

Rudabeh's labour is dangerous. Zal burns the Simurgh's feather, and the bird tells him how to deliver the child safely. The baby, Rostam, is enormous and soon has the strength of a grown man.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

A quiet chapter. Zev must reach the mountain before dawn to burn the feather and bring back Saena's advice and healing herbs. Ra's childhood follows as a short montage of training mini-games.

BOSS / SET PIECE

None.

EARNS

Introduces Ra, the main hero, and the Hearthvale hub.

12 The Salt Merchant

Shahnameh source: ***The White Elephant and Mount Sepand***

REGION Hearthvale outskirts | PLAY Boss rush + infiltration | MAP PIN 12

THE STORY

As a child, Rostam kills a raging white elephant with his grandfather's mace. His first mission is to take the fortress on Mount Sepand by disguising himself as a salt merchant.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Part one: young Ra wakes to screams. A maddened white elephant is loose in the village; protect villagers and land the final blow. Part two: Ra hides in a salt caravan to enter the fortress of Sepand and opens the gates from inside.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The White Elephant: charge and stun pattern (the Reed Lion's big brother).

EARNS

Grandfather's mace. Disguise mechanic.

13 Ember

Shahnameh source: ***Rostam Chooses Rakhsh***

REGION Hearthvale plains | PLAY Taming mini-game | MAP PIN 13

THE STORY

Rostam searches for a horse strong enough to carry him and chooses a wild, rose-coloured colt, Rakhsh, after wrestling its mother. Horse and rider become inseparable.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Ra tests horse after horse; each one buckles under his hand. A wild red colt runs with a fierce mare. Taming is a rhythm-and-balance mini-game. From now on, Ember can be called for fast travel and chase scenes.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The mare, defending her colt (non-lethal).

EARNS

Ember, the horse: riding levels and fast travel between hearths.

14 The Heir on the Mountain

Shahnameh source: ***Kay Qobad from Mount Alborz***

REGION Sky Spine | PLAY Escort | MAP PIN 14

THE STORY

With the throne empty and Afrasiab invading, Zal sends Rostam to fetch Kay Qobad, a royal heir living quietly on Mount Alborz. On the way back Rostam lifts Afrasiab out of his saddle by the belt.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Ride Ember up the Sky Spine to find Kaedan, a royal heir living as a hermit, and escort him down through Dusk Khan scouts. Climax: a cavalry duel where Ra grabs Varak, the Dusk Khan, by the belt before his guards drag him away.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Varak, first duel: he cannot be beaten yet; survive and grab the belt.

EARNS

Ra's rival is introduced. Grab-and-throw move.

15 The Seven Trials (The Current Game)

Shahnameh source: ***Kay Kavus in Mazandaran and Rostam's Seven Labours***

REGION Hearthvale → Frostwood | PLAY Main campaign · 7 regions | MAP PIN 15

THE STORY

King Kay Kavus marches on Mazandaran, land of the divs, and is blinded and captured by the White Div. Rostam takes the short, deadly road: a lion, a waterless desert, a dragon, a witch, Olad, Arzhang Div and finally the White Div, whose blood cures the king's eyes.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

This is MeetRa episode one, already in development. King Aurel the Vain marches north, and the Pale Giant swallows the Dawnfire and blinds his guard. Ra takes the Road of Seven Trials: the Reed Lion, the Thirsting Sands, the Night Serpent, the Veiled Witch, the Mountain Warden, the Horned Warlord and the Pale Giant.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Seven bosses, one per trial. See the game design document.

EARNS

Saena's Feather, Ember Burst, Hunter's Lasso, Truthlight, the four Dawnblade shards.

16 The Copper Coast

Shahnameh source: ***Kay Kavus in Hamavaran and the Flying Throne***

REGION Copper Coast | PLAY Prison break + comedy set piece | MAP PIN 16

THE STORY

Kay Kavus marries Sudabeh, princess of Hamavaran, and is imprisoned by her father; Rostam frees him. Later the king ties eagles to his throne to fly to heaven and crashes in a forest.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Ra frees King Aurel and his new queen, Sedra, from the Copper King's sea fortress, with tides that flood and drain the dungeon. Epilogue: Aurel straps eagles to his throne. The player steers the flight until it crashes into a forest and Ra has to carry the king home.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The Copper King's war galley.

EARNS

Swimming and tide levels.

17 The Seven Hunters

Shahnameh source: ***The Hunt of the Seven Heroes***

REGION Duskland border | PLAY Co-op · party chapter | MAP PIN 17

THE STORY

Rostam and the great champions hold a hunting feast on Turanian land. Afrasiab attacks, and the heroes win the fight.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

An optional chapter in which Ra and six companions hunt on the Duskland border. Swap between heroes, each with one signature move (archer, spear, lasso...). Midway the Dusk Khan's army ambushes the feast.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Dusk Khan's war elephants.

EARNS

Hero swap system, later used in the Twelve Duels.

18 Father and Son

Shahnameh source: ***Rostam and Sohrab***

REGION Silverhill → White Fortress | PLAY Duel chapter · tragedy | MAP PIN 18

THE STORY

On a hunt in Samangan, Rostam spends a night with Princess Tahmineh. Their son Sohrab grows up in Turan, leads an army into Iran and fights his father without either knowing the truth. Rostam kills him and learns too late who he is.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Ember is stolen in Silverhill, and Ra meets Lady Iris. Years later the player controls Sorin, a young champion of the Dusk Khan, taking the White Fortress (a duel with Gerda the Shieldmaiden). The finale is a three-round duel played from both sides; the player cannot avoid the ending.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Ra vs Sorin: three duels on three days.

EARNS

The armband token (story item). Unlocks the hard-mode 'Sorin's Path'.

19 Through the Fire

Shahnameh source: ***Siavash and the Trial by Fire***

REGION Crownhold | PLAY Auto-runner set piece | MAP PIN 19

THE STORY

Prince Siavash rejects the advances of his stepmother Sudabeh, who accuses him. He proves his innocence by riding through a mountain of fire, then leaves for Turan to avoid a dishonourable war.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Queen Sedra accuses Prince Aven. The trial is a pure auto-runner: two walls of fire, Aven on a black horse, the player only jumps and dodges. No damage allowed. Clearing it unlocks the Fireproof Cloak.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The fire corridor itself.

EARNS

Fireproof Cloak (fire resistance charm).

20 The Garden City

Shahnameh source: ***Siavash in Turan***

REGION Aven's City | PLAY City builder + doomed defence | MAP PIN 20

THE STORY

Siavash is welcomed by Afrasiab, marries his daughter Farangis and builds the beautiful city of Siavashgerd. The jealous Garsivaz poisons Afrasiab's mind, and Siavash is killed. A plant grows from his blood.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Aven builds a garden city in the Duskland with Princess Faye. Pleasant building and festival levels slowly fill with dread as Garsk spreads lies. The player sees the trap coming and cannot stop it.

BOSS / SET PIECE

None. A last stand on the road, which cannot be won.

EARNS

The Blood-Flower: a healing plant that appears in every later Duskland level.

21 Seven Years Searching

Shahnameh source: ***Giv Brings Kay Khosrow Home***

REGION Duskland → Ashen River | PLAY Open exploration | MAP PIN 21

THE STORY

Siavash's son Kay Khosrow grows up hidden among shepherds in Turan. The hero Giv searches for him for seven years, finds him, and escorts him and Farangis back across the Oxus.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Gale the Seeker wanders the Duskland for years (shown by changing seasons) looking for Corin, Aven's son. An open, non-linear region with clues hidden in villages. Then an escort run to the Ashen River with the Dusk Khan's riders closing in. Corin crosses the river on horseback without a boat.

BOSS / SET PIECE

River crossing chase.

EARNS

Seasons system for open regions.

22 The Brother on the Hill

Shahnameh source: ***The Tragedy of Forud***

REGION Bright Fort | PLAY Tower defence (reversed) | MAP PIN 22

THE STORY

Forud, another son of Siavash, lives in a fortress on the army's route. Through misunderstanding and the commander Tus's pride, the Iranian army attacks him and he is killed.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Play Prince Fen defending his hill fort with a bow against an army that is actually on his side. Every arrow choice matters: you can wound, warn or spare. The ending changes only in its final scene.

BOSS / SET PIECE

General Tusk, the proud commander.

EARNS

Bow aiming (touch drag-to-aim).

23 The Mountain Siege

Shahnameh source: ***The War with Kamus of Kashan***

REGION Hamavan Heights | PLAY Siege defence | MAP PIN 23

THE STORY

A huge Turanian alliance including the giant champion Kamus traps the Iranian army on Mount Hamavan. Rostam arrives and catches Kamus with his lasso.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

The army is trapped on a mountaintop. Defend the camp at night; scout by day. When Ra and Ember finally arrive, the Hunter's Lasso returns in a giant-catching boss fight.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Kamen of the Hills, a giant who throws boulders.

EARNS

Lasso upgrade: drag giants to the ground.

24 The Whirlwind Ogre

Shahnameh source: ***Rostam and Akvan Div***

REGION Inner Sea | PLAY Trickster boss | MAP PIN 24

THE STORY

Akvan, a div in the form of a wild ass, steals sleeping Rostam, lifting the ground beneath him, and asks whether he wants to be thrown into the sea or onto the mountains. Rostam answers cleverly and survives.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

A golden wild horse leads Ra on a chase until he sleeps. He wakes in the sky, carried by the Whirlwind Ogre, who asks 'the sea or the mountains?' The answer the player picks decides the next level: a swimming escape or a mountain fall. Both end in a rematch.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The Whirlwind Ogre: vanishes and reappears; read the wind to find it.

EARNS

Choice-driven level branching.

25 The Stone Pit

Shahnameh source: ***Bijan and Manijeh***

REGION Stone Pit | PLAY Two-character puzzle | MAP PIN 25

THE STORY

The young hero Bijan falls in love with Afrasiab's daughter Manijeh. He is caught and thrown into a pit under a great stone. Rostam disguises himself as a merchant, finds him through Manijeh and lifts the stone.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Bran is trapped in a pit under a giant stone. Mira lowers food each night. The player switches between Mira above, hiding from guards, and Bran below, keeping hope (a stamina meter). Ra arrives as a merchant; a ring baked in bread is the signal. Ra's final lift is a button-mash heroic moment.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Guard captain at the pit's edge.

EARNS

Merchant disguise returns; caravan trading screen.

26 The Twelve Duels

Shahnameh source: ***The Twelve Combats***

REGION Duskland plain | PLAY Boss gauntlet | MAP PIN 26

THE STORY

Instead of a full battle, the two armies agree to let their champions fight in pairs. The Iranian heroes win almost every duel.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

A gauntlet of twelve one-on-one duels, each with a different hero from the swap roster and a different opponent style. Perfect for short mobile sessions; each duel is a two-minute fight with a star rating.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Twelve champions, one per duel.

EARNS

Arena mode for replay.

27 The Dusk Khan's End

Shahnameh source: ***The Great War and the End of Afrasiab***

REGION Lake of Hiding | PLAY Epic finale + chase | MAP PIN 27

THE STORY

Kay Khosrow leads the final war against Afrasiab, who flees and hides in a lake. The hermit Hum catches him, and Afrasiab is executed for the murder of Siavash.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

The full army marches on the Dusk Khan's capital. Varak escapes and hides beneath a mountain lake. Hume the Hermit, a quiet side character met earlier, tricks him to the surface. Final duel on a stormy shore.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Varak, the Dusk Khan: the long-awaited final duel with Ra's rival.

EARNS

End of the Hero Age arc. Unlocks the epilogue.

28 Into the Snow

Shahnameh source: ***Kay Khosrow Leaves the World***

REGION Sky Spine heights | PLAY Quiet ending level | MAP PIN 28

THE STORY

At the height of his power, Kay Khosrow fears becoming proud like Jamshid. He gives up the throne, walks into the mountains and disappears in a snowstorm. Several heroes who follow him die in the snow.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

A meditative final level of Book II. King Corin walks into the mountains; the player follows with the companions in a slowly rising snowstorm. No enemies. Each companion stops at a different point to say goodbye.

BOSS / SET PIECE

None.

EARNS

Credits for Book II. Corin's crown becomes a collectible.

29 The Exile in the West

Shahnameh source: ***Goshtasp in Rum***

REGION Marble West | PLAY Monster hunt | MAP PIN 29

THE STORY

Prince Goshtasp, angry at his father, goes to Rum. Princess Katayun chooses him as husband; to win the emperor's favour he kills a monstrous wolf and a dragon.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Prince Gast arrives in the Marble West as a nameless stranger. Katya picks him at a choosing ceremony. Two monster hunts follow: a wolf the size of a house in the forest, and a sea dragon on the cliffs.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The Great Wolf; the Cliff Dragon.

EARNS

Hunting traps and bait.

30 The Fire Prophet

Shahnameh source: ***The Prophet and the War with Arjasp***

REGION Crownhold | PLAY Defence of the sacred fire | MAP PIN 30

THE STORY

Zoroaster brings a new faith to Goshtasp's court and the king accepts it. Arjasp of Turan demands they give it up; war follows and the young hero Esfandiyar rises.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

A wandering prophet plants a cypress at the palace and lights a new sacred fire. Ardak of the Duskland attacks to put it out. Defend the temple in waves while Prince Aspen, freed from prison, rides to help.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Ardak's siege engine.

EARNS

The Great Cypress: a giant hub tree that grows as the story continues.

31 The Bronze Trials

Shahnameh source: ***The Seven Labours of Esfandiyar***

REGION Duskland → Brazen Fortress | PLAY Remix campaign | MAP PIN 31

THE STORY

To rescue his sisters, Esfandiyar takes his own road of seven trials: wolves, lions, a dragon, a witch, the Simurgh's mate, snow and a river, before taking the Brazen Fortress.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

A 'mirror' of the Seven Trials. Prince Aspen, the bronze-skinned prince who cannot be wounded, walks a second road of seven trials. Same structure, darker remixed levels, a war chariot with blades. His fourth trial makes him fight Saena's mate, which turns Saena against him.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Seven remix bosses, ending in the Brazen Fortress.

EARNS

New Game+ mode built from the Seven Trials.

32 The Tamarisk Arrow

Shahnameh source: ***Rostam and Esfandiyar***

REGION Hearthvale | PLAY Unwinnable duel → solution | MAP PIN 32

THE STORY

King Goshtasp orders Esfandiyar to bring Rostam in chains. Neither hero wants to fight. Rostam is badly wounded by the invulnerable prince; the Simurgh shows him a tamarisk branch to make an arrow aimed at the eyes.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Old Ra against Prince Aspen. Day one cannot be won: Aspen takes no damage. Night: Ra burns Saena's last feather and she leads him to a tamarisk by the sea. Day two: a bow duel where only a perfect shot to the eyes counts. The game asks twice if you are sure.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Prince Aspen the Bronze.

EARNS

Saena leaves the story. The emotional peak of the saga.

33 The Hunting Ground

Shahnameh source: ***The Death of Rostam***

REGION Shadewell | PLAY Final level of Ra's life | MAP PIN 33

THE STORY

Rostam's jealous half-brother Shaghad lures him on a hunt to a field of pits lined with spears. Rakhsh and Rostam fall in. With his last strength Rostam shoots Shaghad through the tree he hides behind.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Shade, Ra's half-brother, invites him to hunt. Ember refuses to step forward and Ra, for the first time, forces him. The ground gives way. The last playable moment: one arrow, one shot, through a plane tree. Then Faro, Ra's son, carries the story forward.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Shade: one arrow, no second chance.

EARNS

The Book of Ra: an unlockable gallery of everything he did.

Book III: The Age of Crowns

Chapters 34–44

Legend turns into history. Ra's era is over; new heroes inherit his gear and his map. These chapters suit episodic releases and side games, each with its own twist on the core platforming.

34 The River Child

Shahnameh source: ***Homay and Darab***

REGION Two Rivers | PLAY Rafting · growing-up chapter | MAP PIN 34

THE STORY

Queen Homay, fearing for her throne, puts her newborn son Darab in a chest on the Euphrates. A washerman finds and raises him; he grows into a warrior and is recognised as heir.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

The first level is the chest on the river: steer through rapids as a baby (gently comic). Then Dar grows up with a washerman's family, learning to fight by the river. Queen Hela recognises him by the jewel left in the chest.

BOSS / SET PIECE

River Crocodile Lord.

EARNS

Rafting levels.

35 The Last Embrace

Shahnameh source: ***Dara and Iskandar***

REGION Marble West → Crownhold | PLAY Army march + tragedy | MAP PIN 35

THE STORY

Iskandar of Rum (Alexander) invades Iran and defeats King Dara, who is stabbed by his own ministers. Dara dies in Iskandar's arms, asking him to marry his daughter Roshanak.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Play Alexion of the Marble West marching east. Big battles, then a twist: King Dorian is betrayed by his own ministers. Alexion finds him dying and the player chooses whether to punish the traitors.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The traitor ministers.

EARNS

Formation commands for battle levels.

36 The Edge of the World

Shahnameh source: ***The Journeys of Iskandar***

REGION Lightless Land · Wall of Yag | PLAY Exploration anthology | MAP PIN 36

THE STORY

Iskandar travels to the edges of the world: he searches for the Water of Life in the Land of Darkness, builds a wall against Gog and Magog, and meets a talking tree that foretells his death.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

An anthology of short worlds: the Lightless Land (play in total darkness by sound and glowing stones), building the great wall against the Yag swarm (a defence builder) and the Talking Tree, which tells Alexion how many days he has left.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The Yag Swarm.

EARNS

Darkness and sound-based navigation.

37 The Silkworm Fortress

Shahnameh source: ***Ardashir and the Worm of Haftvad***

REGION Wormhold | PLAY Infiltration · boss | MAP PIN 37

THE STORY

Ardashir escapes King Ardavan's court with the maid Golnar. He founds the Sasanian line and defeats Haftvad, whose power comes from a giant worm kept in a fortress and fed on rice and milk.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Ardan and Gala escape the king's stables at night on two horses. Later, Ardan learns that a warlord's power comes from a giant worm fed in a fortress. Disguised as merchants again, he feeds it molten metal.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The Silkworm: a huge worm boss that fills the screen.

EARNS

Molten metal tool (a callback to Hushang's forge).

38 The Polo Field

Shahnameh source: ***Shapur***

REGION Crownhold | PLAY Sport mini-game + escape | MAP PIN 38

THE STORY

Young Shapur, Ardashir's hidden son, is recognised at a polo game. As king he wars with Rome and is once captured, sewn into a donkey skin, and escapes.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

A polo match on horseback reveals young Prince Shay's identity. Years later he is captured in the West and sewn into a hide; a sympathetic maid helps him escape. A stealth-and-ride chapter.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The Western emperor's guard.

EARNS

Polo mini-game (multiplayer on one phone).

39 The Crown Between Lions

Shahnameh source: ***Bahram Gur***

REGION Crownhold · Spice Shore | PLAY Hunting + incognito | MAP PIN 39

THE STORY

Bahram Gur, a famous hunter, claims the throne by taking the crown from between two lions. He hunts with the harpist Azadeh, who mocks a cruel shot and pays for it, and he travels in disguise among his people.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Behr the Hunter wins the crown by taking it from between two chained lions (a call back to the Reed Lion). Hunting levels with Aza the harpist. Later he travels in disguise to the Spice Shore and fights a rhinoceros-like beast and a dragon for its king.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Two crown lions; the Spice Shore dragon.

EARNS

Lute rhythm mini-game; incognito villages.

40 The Famine Granaries

Shahnameh source: ***Mazdak***

REGION Crownhold | PLAY Moral choice chapter | MAP PIN 40

THE STORY

Mazdak preaches that wealth should be shared and gains many followers during a famine. The king's son Anushirvan turns against him, and Mazdak and his followers are killed.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

During a famine the preacher Mazen opens the royal granaries. The player chooses sides through a series of small acts, and the city changes accordingly. Neither side is presented as simply right.

BOSS / SET PIECE

None. The result depends on choices.

EARNS

Reputation system.

41 The Sage's Game

Shahnameh source: ***Anushirvan, Bozorgmehr and Chess***

REGION Crownhold · Spice Shore | PLAY Puzzle chapter | MAP PIN 41

THE STORY

The just king Anushirvan rules with his wise vizier Bozorgmehr. An Indian king sends a chess set as a challenge; Bozorgmehr solves it and invents backgammon in return.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

Sage Mehrun answers riddles from foreign envoys. The Spice Shore sends a strange board game; the player works out the rules by watching. Then Mehrun invents his own dice game and sends it back.

BOSS / SET PIECE

None. A riddle duel with the Spice Shore sages.

EARNS

Chess and backgammon-style mini-games in the hub.

42 The Insulted General

Shahnameh source: ***Bahram Chubin***

REGION Duskland → Crownhold | PLAY Anti-hero campaign | MAP PIN 42

THE STORY

The general Bahram Chubin wins a great victory against the Turks but is insulted by King Hormozd. He rebels, drives Khosrow Parviz from the throne, and is later murdered in exile.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

General Chobe wins an impossible battle against an army of beasts and is sent a spindle and women's clothes as a reward. The player leads his rebellion, a tragic arc that mirrors Sorin and Aven.

BOSS / SET PIECE

The young King Parris (cannot be killed; he escapes).

EARNS

Commander mode with troop orders.

43 The Golden Court

Shahnameh source: ***Khosrow Parviz and Shirin***

REGION Crownhold | PLAY Story chapter | MAP PIN 43

THE STORY

Khosrow Parviz regains his throne and marries Shirin. Late in life he is imprisoned by his son; after his death Shirin takes her own life at his tomb.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

King Parris rebuilds his court and its famous treasures (a moving throne, a musician who plays a song for every day of the year). Shira is a playable character in palace intrigue levels. The ending is handled quietly, off-screen.

BOSS / SET PIECE

Palace coup.

EARNS

Music collectibles: 30 songs, one per hidden room.

44 The Last Hearth

Shahnameh source: ***Yazdegerd and the End of the Kings***

REGION Shadewell → Hearthvale | PLAY Epilogue | MAP PIN 44

THE STORY

The last king, Yazdegerd III, loses the empire to the Arab armies. He flees east and is killed in a mill by a miller who wants his clothes.

THE MEETRA CHAPTER

The last King Yazen flees east with the last flame from the royal hearth. The player carries the flame through every region of the map in reverse. The final scene is in Hearthvale, where the flame is passed to a child, and a feather falls from the sky.

BOSS / SET PIECE

None.

EARNS

True ending of the saga. Links back to Ra and Saena.

Appendix A · Cast

Shahnameh name (for reference only) and the original MeetRa name used in the game.

Shahnameh	MeetRa
Kayumars	**Orem, the Mountain King**
Siamak	**Prince Tamsin**
The Black Div	**The Black Hollow**
Hushang	**Kael the Flint-Striker**
Tahmuras	**Taro the Binder**
Jamshid	**Jarem the Radiant**
Iblis	**The Whispering Cook**
Zahhak	**Vexar, the Twin-Serpent King**
Kaveh	**Bram the Smith**
Fereydun	**Faren**
Salm / Tur / Iraj	**Sael / Torvak / Ilan**
Manuchehr	**Mael**
Sam	**Sarn the Lionheart**
Zal	**Zev the White-Haired**
Rudabeh	**Rue of Kabulmere**
Simurgh	**Saena**
Rostam	**Ra**
Rakhsh	**Ember**
Kay Qobad	**Kaedan**
Kay Kavus	**King Aurel the Vain**
White Div	**The Pale Giant**
Sudabeh	**Queen Sedra**
Afrasiab	**Varak, the Dusk Khan**
Tahmineh	**Lady Iris**
Sohrab	**Sorin**
Gordafarid	**Gerda the Shieldmaiden**
Siavash	**Prince Aven**
Farangis	**Princess Faye**
Garsivaz	**Garsk**
Kay Khosrow	**King Corin**
Giv	**Gale the Seeker**
Forud	**Prince Fen**
Tus	**General Tusk**
Kamus	**Kamen of the Hills**

Akvan Div	**The Whirlwind Ogre**
Bijan / Manijeh	**Bran / Mira**
Hum	**Hume the Hermit**
Goshtasp	**Prince Gast**
Katayun	**Katya**
Zoroaster	**The Fire Prophet**
Arjasp	**Ardak**
Esfandiyar	**Prince Aspen the Bronze**
Shaghad	**Shade**
Faramarz	**Faro**
Homay / Darab	**Queen Hela / Dar**
Dara	**King Dorian**
Iskandar	**Alexion of the Marble West**
Ardashir / Golnar	**Ardan / Gala**
Shapur	**Prince Shay**
Bahram Gur / Azadeh	**Behr the Hunter / Aza**
Mazdak	**Mazen**
Bozorgmehr	**Sage Mehrun**
Bahram Chubin	**General Chobe**
Khosrow Parviz / Shirin	**King Parris / Shira**
Yazdegerd III	**King Yazen**

Appendix B · Places and Mechanics

Places

Shahnameh	MeetRa map
Zabulistan	**Hearthvale**
Mount Alborz	**Sky Spine · Saena's Peak**
Mount Damavand	**Chain Mountain**
Iran (heartland)	**Crownhold**
Mazandaran	**Frostwood**
Caspian Sea	**The Inner Sea**
Turan	**The Duskland**
Oxus (Jayhun)	**The Ashen River**
Siavashgerd	**Aven's City**
Rum	**The Marble West**
Arabia (Zahhak's land)	**The Serpent Sands**
Hamavaran	**The Copper Coast**
India	**The Spice Shore**
Chin	**The Silk East**
Kabul	**Kabulmere · Shadewell**
Samangan	**Silverhill**
Land of Darkness	**The Lightless Land**
Gog and Magog	**The Yag Swarm**

Where each mechanic is introduced

Mechanic	Ch.
Animal ally calls	1
Hearths (checkpoints)	2
Binding enemies · Script Stones	3
Aura resource	4
Stealth and hiding	5
Ox-Head Mace · rallying allies	6
World map	7
War Horn shockwave	8
Saena's Feather	9
Rope climbing	10
Hub village	11
Disguise	12
Horse riding · fast travel	13
Grab and throw	14
Ember Burst · Lasso · Truthlight	15
Swimming · tides	16
Hero swap	17
Fire resistance	19
Seasons in open regions	21
Bow aiming (drag to aim)	22
Branching by choice	24
Two-character puzzles	25
Arena mode	26
New Game+	31
Rafting	34
Formation commands	35
Darkness navigation by sound	36
Polo (local multiplayer)	38
Rhythm mini-game	39
Reputation	40
Board-game mini-games	41
Troop orders	42